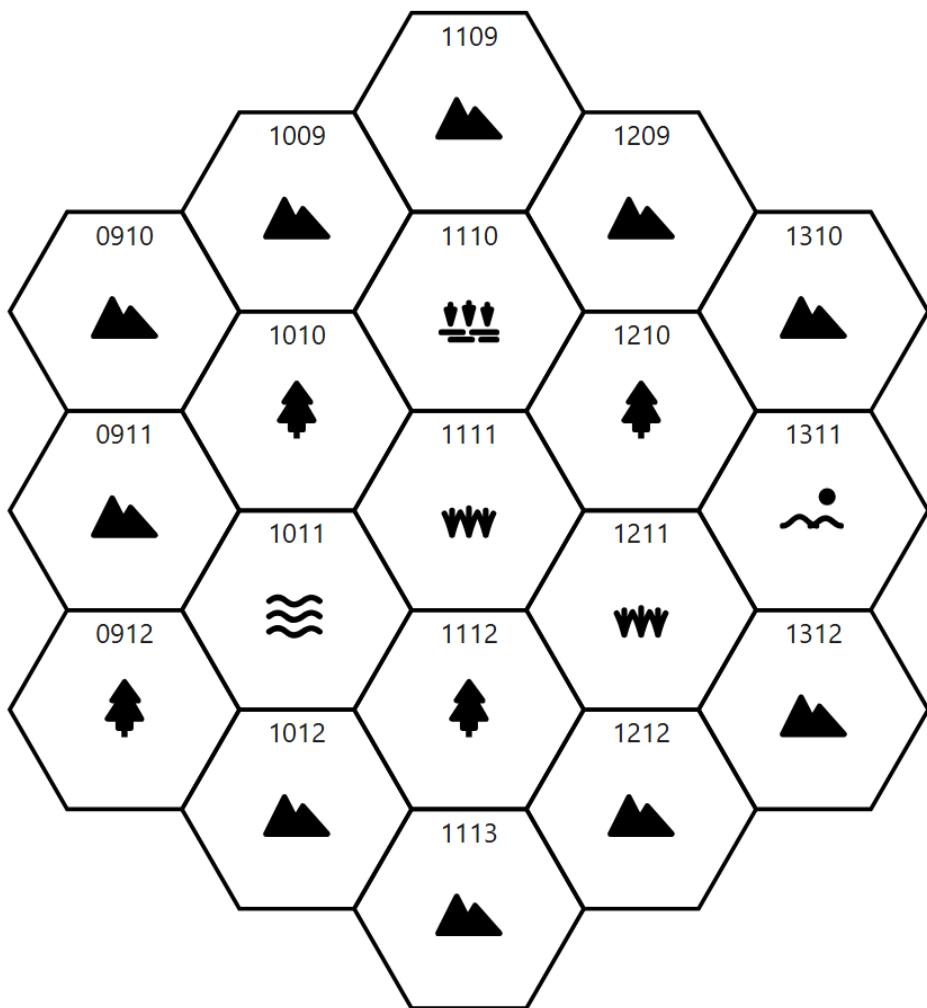


THE CAULDRON



Range Map: 6-mile hexes · 19 total hexes · Appx. 600 sq. miles

The Cauldron is a bowl of black mountains encircling a long-forgotten country: jungle, fen, and grassland populated by strange creatures older than living memory and lost in time under a permanent dome of impenetrable mist. There are only two ways down, and getting in is less than half the battle.

Points of Interest

Every range possesses a number of interesting locations across its 19 hexes.

0912 – The Green Gap

Between the towering mountains runs a hilly, tree-choked gap that grants entry into the Cauldron. The forest is so thick here as to be almost unnavigable, forcing travelers to keep to the uncommonly wide game trails.

1010 – The Painted Cave

A yawning cave mouth, obscured by thick roots that hang like curtains, its walls painted top to bottom with creatures no one outside the bowl has a name for. The most ferocious thing depicted here slumbers restlessly at the back of the cave.

1111 – Lastcamp

Two hundred souls behind a ramshackle stockade, descended from an expedition that climbed down into the Cauldron some generations prior and never climbed back out. They are in many ways a primitive but otherwise friendly group with a little bread, a lot of meat, and a smith with a knack for working rare metals.

1210 – The Creeping Idol

A shrine on a ridge above the northeast trees—cleaned, freshly painted, and in regular use—though by whom, no creature that loves the day knows. The figure at its center is neither man nor beast, and the Idol-Keepers, as they are called, gather here in the deep hours of the night. It is said that by the light of the full moon the idol comes to life and stalks the surrounding forest, thirsty for warm blood.

1310 – The Slag Adit

An old working cut into the eastern wall, with fresh spoil of some rare ore heaped outside it. Another expedition is already here, excavating the material and holding a map promising even more; they have not yet decided whether you are competition.

1311 – The Smoking Ground

A broad shoulder of ash and pumice on the eastern rim, where nothing grows and even the winds refuse to pass over it. The ground here is warm enough to feel through your boots. Last season, a sinkhole opened up, revealing a network of tunnels that look too geometric to be simply lava tubes.

Additionally, three factions haunt this land that time forgot: *The Lastcamp Folk*, who farm, hunt, and subsist—and owe something a debt that is quickly coming due; the *Idol-Keepers*, ape-like beastmen who worship the strange stone idol with human sacrifices; and the *Rival Expedition*, who have found precious resources in the bowl and will stop at nothing to keep them all to themselves.

Learn more about The Cauldron at <https://td10.org/atlas/cauldron>